



A MacBook that has gone through SkinJam

mobile phone covered in diamonds; well, you can have that done to your phone too. Just visit the store called SkinJam, located in Mumbai and Bengaluru, and you can get this done. You have more of an option to personalise considering the fact that there is no limit to certain models that you can have a skin added to, in comparison to **decalgirl.com** where you have to stick to the models present on the site.

There is a chance you can even get a skin for your PC cabinet which will look uber cool. The main drawback here is that you can't do it yourself and the designs are mostly fixed, but you can see the employees of the shop work on your gadget, good for the people who don't want to get their hands messy.



Customising a digital camera is also possible now

Alright, enough about the small devices, what about adding that custom feel to your best asset? Stop thinking too much, all we're talking about is your computer, which most of us geeks would have understood right away.

One of the best ways to start off your customisation experience is by modifying your cabinet. Those of you who have deep pockets and don't mind spending quite a bit can just buy the most expensive cabinet out there which will be unique in a way, as not many people will actually spend that much on it. But, for the rest of us who fall under the value segment will need to look for other means to satisfy our thirst for customisation. The customisation we're talking about is case modding, which started as a hobby for some, who have now turned it into a profession. We spoke



The phone covered with expensive crystals - toys for the rich and famous

to Waseem Yusuf, a 21-year old B.Com graduate who has converted his hobby of case modding into a profession and has also started his own web store.

Where does one start with case modding, well firstly we'd suggest you purchase a fairly priced cabinet that you know you're going to use to mod, and won't feel sad even if something were to it in the process. This point is also agreed by Yusuf, who himself found modding tricky when he first started.

Case modding, doesn't necessarily have

INSIDE THE MIND OF A CASE MODDER

We also got in touch with Waseem Yusuf and found out what drove him to this extreme profession

What made you take up Modding as a profession?

Since childhood, I've always been fascinated by computers. I saw a computer for the first time when I was in 3rd standard and there was instant love between the two, which has been growing ever since. So as my love for computers, I wanted to try something different. It all started as experimentation with my PC and the results have been pretty impressive! Slowly I started modding my friends' computers and finally took it up as a profession. Though I believe modding is a way of expressing oneself and not exactly a profession, every mod is like a work of art.

Did you start with a normal job and then just realised that it's not for you?

I was a trainer at NIIT for Java and .NET. I'm basically very creative, so teaching programming language was quite boring for me. I decided to start my own business; as I said, my love for computers have always been there all my life and slowly I realised this is what I wanted to do in life.

In the initial phase when you started, were you just good at it, or did you practice a lot before opening up shop?

Initially, it was a little tricky to do it, but once I got the hang of it it was much easier. Modding isn't just about cutting sheets and placing cooling fans. Each mod is unique and requires different skills. This makes each mod special in its own way. Like I said, modding is like art.

Where do you draw your inspiration or ideas for each unique mod?

I get inspired by a lot of things such as



colours or cars/bikes. But modding is a way of expressing oneself and so I try to get inspiration from who I am.

Do you mod anything other than PC cabinets? (eg. Xbox360s, PS2s, PS3s, etc)

We haven't tried modding consoles, but yes it's a great idea to mod one's consoles to make them unique.

What are the tools that you use for modding?

We use some basic tools such as Dremel, Drill, Spray Paint, Hole saw, Jig saw, Double Sided Tape, Laser Cutting, Laser Etching. Every mod requires use of different tools; hence, at times not all of these tools come into use. More than the tools one needs the skills. Jobs such as etching the Logo on the acrylic sheet require highly specific machines.

How easy is it to obtain these tools?

These tools are used in many other industries and can be obtained from most hardware shops. Modding is more about skills, creativity and one needs to concentrate & put in a lot of effort. I have always believed in quality and to get the best quality one needs to be precise in his work. And to get perfection, the quality of tools used matter a lot.